



YOU ARE **38 WEEKS EXACTLY**

14 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The back of the hand is held up against the mouth in this image. Your baby will be practicing suckling at every opportunity, but this will be with parts of the hands, thumbs, or fingers, since it's no longer easy to reach the toes.

“ If you haven't found out the sex of your baby, the excitement will be building; if you have, you can decide on a name, at least. ”

Knowing the sex of your baby can be useful. In addition to choosing a name, you may want to buy items that you feel are more suitable for a boy or a girl. Remember, however, there's a chance that the scan (see [Your 20-week scan](#)) gave you misleading information. The only way to be absolutely certain of the baby's gender is if you found out following a diagnostic test, such as [amniocentesis](#) or [chorionic villus sampling](#).

If you know the sex, you won't have the same incentive of a surprise at the end of your labor, but you may feel you can bond more closely with your baby during pregnancy and picture what they will be like as a newborn.

If you don't know the sex yet, then you will have a well-earned surprise after your hard work in labor. Some women who don't know the sex of their babies say that they have a strong instinct that the baby is a particular sex but may be quite surprised when they have a baby of the opposite sex.

It may help to know that, overall 105 male babies are born for every 100 female babies worldwide.

If you're really curious and want to guess the sex of your baby, you might want to bear in mind these old wives' tales:

If your hands are soft, it's said you're having a girl; if they're rough, you're having a boy.

If the mother picks up her coffee cup with two hands, it's a girl; if she picks it up by the handle, it's a boy.

If you have a sensitive belly button, it's a girl; if you have cold feet, it's almost certainly a boy!

TRUST YOUR BODY

Be reassured that your body is designed to handle the pain of labor! Nobody likes pain, but your body's endorphin levels will increase during labor to help you cope with it. So it's reassuring to know that as the intensity of the contractions builds, so does your ability to handle them.